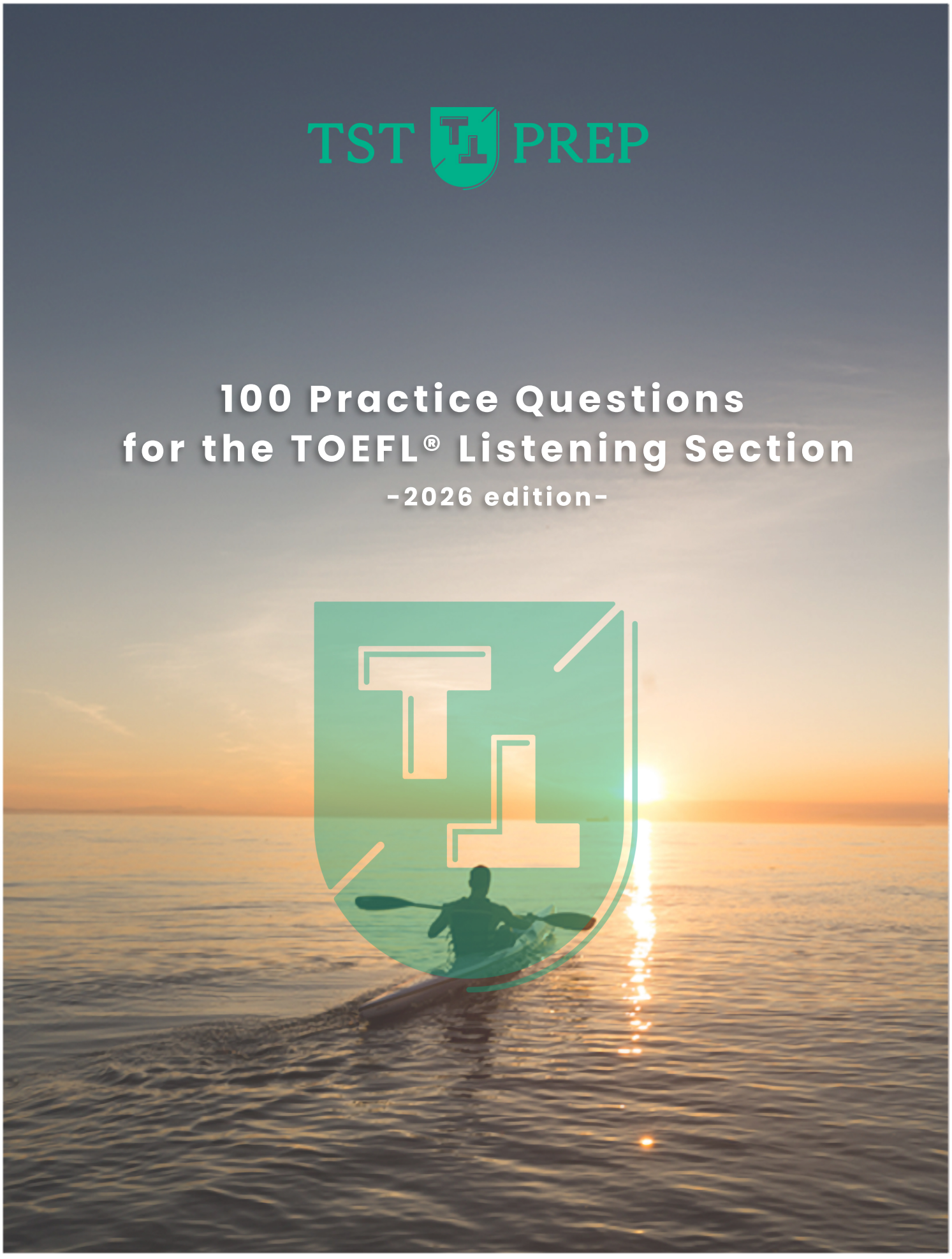
TST PREP

100 Practice Questions for the TOEFL® Listening Section

-2026 edition-



100 Practice Questions For the TOEFL® Listening Section

TST Prep

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Introduction

This book is a compilation of over 100 TOEFL Listening questions. These questions reflect the latest update of the exam.

In the TOEFL Listening, there are four question types:

- Listen and Choose
- Listen to a Conversation
- Listen to an Announcement
- Listen to an Academic Talk

You will have at least one of each passage type on test day. This document includes 30 Listen and Choose questions, 15 Listen to a Conversation passages totaling 30 questions, 12 Listen to an Announcement passages totaling 24 questions, and 10 Listen to an Academic Talk passages totaling 40 questions.

Note that on test day, you will only have to answer between 35-48 questions. This document is meant to provide you with practice and answer explanations so you know what to expect. It is not designed to represent the test experience.

The first thing you may notice is that the layout is different from the TOEFL. Most importantly, the link to the audio passage and the questions about the passage share the same page. Be sure to set up your screen so that you only see the link and vocabulary first. **Wait until after you listen to the passage to read the questions** (if you want to mimic the test conditions).

You can go to our official website at tstprep.com if you would like to experience the TOEFL iBT Listening section test.

When you are done, you can check the end of answers and explanations to every question.

Listen and Choose

Choose the best response.

Set 1



1.
- **a.** Yes, she answered all my questions after class.
- **b.** The professor teaches on Monday mornings.
- **c.** I'm planning to talk to her next week.
- **d.** No, but I read the course syllabus.



2.
- **a.** The office has been repainted.
- **b.** It usually opens at eight o'clock.
- **c.** Most of the team was working from home.
- **d.** Yes, I noticed that yesterday.



3.
- **a.** Dr. Lopez, the researcher from Argentina.
- **b.** The session will last about an hour.
- **c.** Yes, I've seen her present before.
- **d.** There are three seats near the front.



4.
- **a.** The theater tickets were quite expensive.
- **b.** The show starts in fifteen minutes.
- **c.** I parked there once last year.
- **d.** Barely, but I got a spot two blocks away.



5.
- **a.** I'll make another appointment next month.
- **b.** The doctor's office closes at six o'clock.
- **c.** It should heal completely if I rest for a week.
- **d.** Yes, I had an X-ray yesterday.



6.

a. The weather there is usually nice.
b. The airport is about thirty minutes away.
c. Yes, I love to travel every summer.
d. We're visiting my cousins in Spain for two weeks.



7.

a. I lost a jacket once in the same place.
b. Right after paying for coffee at the station.
c. The wallet is black and leather.
d. I'll check the café again later.



8.

a. The elevator doors are silver and glass.
b. Finally, yes—it's working perfectly now.
c. It's on the left side of the hallway.
d. I live on the fourth floor.



9.

a. It's been postponed.
b. In the main auditorium.
c. Yes, tickets are required.
d. Professor Adams from the physics department.



10.

a. They're due next Thursday.
b. The drop box is right by the entrance.
c. I finished reading two of them.
d. I need to borrow more before the weekend.

Set 2



11.

a. I hope it went well.
b. The appointment was short.
c. My dentist just started this week.
d. I had one last month.



12.

a. No, it was delayed by an hour.
b. The next one's already full.
c. Yes, I'll text you when I find the car.
d. The station is downtown.



13.

a. I already packed my suitcase.
b. Yes, they'll check them at the gate.
c. The airport is far from here.
d. No, I don't have mine.



14.

a. Yes, I met the manager the other day.
b. It was rescheduled for next week.
c. No, I haven't heard back from my old boss yet.
d. The office was quiet until the interview began.



15.

a. His flight was canceled yesterday.
b. Yes, I saw them yesterday outside my dorm.
c. No, they're still deciding where to go next.
d. They decided to come next month instead.



16.

a. I'll play a different song next.
b. I didn't realize it was that loud.
c. The speaker's battery is low.
d. I already changed the playlist.



17.

a. The client meeting is every Thursday.
b. I already sent the updated slides.
c. They're visiting from the New York office.
d. Marcus offered to take the lead this time.



18.

a. I waited outside last time.
b. The weather's nice today.
c. Not at all, I just got here myself.
d. The clock's a little fast.



19.

a. Yes, but the application is quite long.
b. No, I read about the internship online.
c. Yes, I sent it to Career Services yesterday.
d. No, my friend works there.



20.

a. Ms. Grant from the marketing department.
b. It starts at nine sharp.
c. The meeting room is small.
d. I led the last one.

Set 3



21.

a. Yes, the orientation was yesterday.
b. No, but I've heard she's from Brazil.
c. She lives in the dorms.
d. I saw an exchange program online.



22.

a. Yes, but they forgot one of my shirts.
b. No, I went to be early.
c. Yes, the restaurant is next to the bank.
d. But my clothes are still wet.



23.

a. It was at my apartment.
b. The party ended early.
c. I sent you an invitation.
d. That's okay, maybe next time.



24.

a. The house next door is blue.
b. They moved in last month.
c. I saw them outside last week.
d. Let's keep the volume low for now.



25.

a. No, it's across from the gym.
b. No, the exams start next Monday.
c. I studied there yesterday.
d. Yes, until midnight for the next two weeks.



26.

a. I did, but it broke in the wind.
b. Yes, I usually carry one.
c. The weather looks better now.
d. I forgot mine at work.



27.

a. I bought that brand before.
b. It's next to the cereal box.
c. The label's written in Spanish.
d. Here, let me give it a try.



28.

a. The battery icon just changed colors.
b. You can borrow my charger if you need it.
c. I prefer using desktop computers.
d. The store sells electronics too.



29.

a. I'll drop them off on my way home.
b. The letters are on the desk.
c. I checked the mailbox earlier.
d. The post office closes soon.



30.

a. Glad I could help.
b. The advice worked well.
c. I'll send you a message.
d. I read the article you sent.

Listen to a Conversation

1.

Listen to a conversation.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

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31. Why does the man mention double-checking their flight times?

- **a.** He plans to change the time of departure so they can arrive earlier.
- **b.** He forgot to confirm the flight details earlier.
- **c.** He wants to ensure they can pick up the car on time.
- **d.** He thinks the rental location might close early.

32. What does the man suggest the woman do?

- **a.** Take care of booking the rental car
- **b.** Wait until they arrive to rent a car
- **c.** Call the airline to verify their schedule
- **d.** Pay for the hotel instead of the vehicle

2.

Listen to a conversation.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

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33. Why can't the man reschedule his doctor's appointment for later in the day?

- **a.** The appointment is for a required medical test.
- **b.** The doctor's office closes early on weekdays.
- **c.** He already confirmed another meeting then.
- **d.** The only available time is next week.

34. What will the man probably do next?

- **a.** Attend the meeting instead of the appointment
- **b.** Cancel his doctor's appointment for tomorrow
- **c.** Send an email to his supervisor about the conflict
- **d.** Ask a coworker to take notes during the meeting

3.

Listen to a conversation.



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35. What task does the man agree to complete?

- **a.** Print the agenda for everyone
- **b.** Inform the client about the change
- **c.** Resend the meeting invitation with updated details
- **d.** Reserve another room in the building

36. What can be inferred about the company's meeting rooms?

- **a.** Scheduling conflicts happen frequently.
- **b.** They are rarely used for client meetings.
- **c.** They are being renovated.
- **d.** They are only available for online calls.

4.

Listen to a conversation.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

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37. Where did the woman lose her ID?

- **a.** In the library
- **b.** On a field trip
- **c.** During her next class
- **d.** In the student center

38. What does the man say about getting a new ID?

- **a.** She will have to wait a few days for a replacement.
- **b.** She can borrow a temporary pass from the library.
- **c.** Students must fill out an online form first.
- **d.** It can be printed at the student center.

5.

Listen to a conversation.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

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39. Where does the man eventually find his keys?

- **a.** In the living room
- **b.** On the kitchen table
- **c.** Inside a drawer
- **d.** In his jacket pocket

40. What can be inferred about the man?

- **a.** He often misplaces his belongings.
- **b.** He recently bought a new car.
- **c.** He was in a hurry to leave.
- **d.** He does not trust the woman's advice.

6.

Listen to a conversation.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

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41. Why does the woman plan to book the tickets soon?

- **a.** She wants to get better seats.
- **b.** Ticket prices are expected to increase.
- **c.** The trip is still unconfirmed.
- **d.** She needs to cancel another reservation.

42. What does the man ask the woman?

- **a.** To wait to buy tickets in person
- **b.** If there are any earlier trains
- **c.** How much he owes for the tickets
- **d.** To look for hotel options near the station

7.

Listen to a conversation.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

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43. Where does the woman think the umbrella was left?

- **a.** In the office where he works
- **b.** Inside the man's car after the meal
- **c.** At the restaurant where they ate dinner
- **d.** At the front desk of his apartment building

44. Why does the woman suggest calling the restaurant?

- **a.** They may be holding the umbrella for the man.
- **b.** She wants to confirm whether they are still open.
- **c.** She believes the staff saw him leave it on a chair.
- **d.** She knows the man often eats at the same restaurant.

8.

Listen to a conversation.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

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45. Why does the man offer to pick up the cake?

- **a.** He needs to confirm that the bakery is still open.
- **b.** He wants to make sure the cake looks perfect.
- **c.** He ordered the same cake for another event.
- **d.** He will already be driving near the bakery.

46. What does the woman advise the man to do?

- **a.** Check that the bakery spells the name correctly
- **b.** Buy candles for the top of the cake
- **c.** Ask for a discount if the cake is late
- **d.** Pick up extra cupcakes in case guests want more

9.

Listen to a conversation.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

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47. Where does the man plan to ride his bike?

- **a.** Across a downtown bridge route
- **b.** Around the city park
- **c.** Through a nearby mountain path
- **d.** Along the riverside trail

48. Why does the woman mention sunscreen and water?

- **a.** Because the weather forecast predicts light rain that day
- **b.** Because the rental shop requires riders to bring them
- **c.** Because the trail has limited shade along certain areas
- **d.** Because the man plans to ride early in the morning

10.

Listen to a conversation.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

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49. What has the man already done to address the noise issue?

- **a.** Left polite notes for his neighbors about the loud music
- **b.** Spoken directly to the building manager twice
- **c.** Moved to a different apartment in the building
- **d.** Filed an official complaint with local authorities

50. What does the woman advise the man to do?

- **a.** Talk to the building manager before the weekend
- **b.** Confront the neighbors directly about the problem
- **c.** Wait until next week to see if it happens again
- **d.** Consider moving to another location

11.

Listen to a conversation.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

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51. What does the woman say about the yoga instructor?

- **a.** The instructor is good at teaching beginners.
- **b.** The instructor teaches only advanced-level classes.
- **c.** The instructor gives private lessons near the park.
- **d.** The instructor just started working at the studio.

52. What will the man probably do next?

- **a.** Invite his friend to join the class too
- **b.** Look online for reviews of the studio before he goes
- **c.** Buy new workout clothes for the class
- **d.** Attend the free yoga class on Saturday

12.

Listen to a conversation.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

53. What does the man say about the sushi restaurant?

- **a.** The portions are small, and it gets crowded.
- **b.** The menu is limited but reasonably priced.
- **c.** The food is fresh and the service is quick.
- **d.** The atmosphere is nice, but a reservation is required.

54. What will the woman probably do this afternoon?

- **a.** Call the restaurant to reserve a table.
- **b.** Look for online reviews about the sushi
- **c.** Ask friends to join her for dinner
- **d.** Visit the restaurant in person to check prices

13.

Listen to a conversation.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

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55. What can be inferred about the occasion?

- **a.** They are meeting coworkers for a business dinner.
- **b.** They are celebrating a birthday.
- **c.** They are hosting an engagement dinner for friends.
- **d.** They are dining out to celebrate their anniversary.

56. Why does the man mention dessert being included?

- **a.** The restaurant is offering it as a free service.
- **b.** He wants to remind the woman to order dessert.
- **c.** He plans to pay for dessert separately.
- **d.** He is suggesting they skip the birthday cake.

14.

Listen to a conversation.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

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57. Why does the man mention dessert?

- **a.** To show he is open to adjusting their plans
- **b.** To suggest they go to a different restaurant instead
- **c.** To remind the woman about her favorite dessert shop
- **d.** To convince the woman to eat earlier in the evening

58. What does the woman suggest about the restaurant?

- **a.** The curry might not be as good as people say.
- **b.** The restaurant is probably too crowded at dinner time.
- **c.** They should make a reservation before going.
- **d.** The quality of service may vary depending on the staff.

15.

Listen to a conversation.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

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59. Why does the woman suggest emailing the advisor now?

- **a.** To avoid any future problems with his advisor
- **b.** To request a later appointment time
- **c.** To ask for an extension on the class assignment
- **d.** To confirm the economics classroom location

60. What does the man still need from his advisor?

- **a.** A signature for a scholarship form
- **b.** An economics textbook
- **c.** Approval to change his major
- **d.** An email to his professor

1.

Listen to an announcement from the university library.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

61. What is the main purpose of the announcement?

- **a.** To introduce a new online reservation system
- **b.** To promote library services
- **c.** To remind students to return library books
- **d.** To inform students about new library hours

62. According to the announcement, when will the new hours begin?

- **a.** Next Monday
- **b.** This weekend
- **c.** Midnight on weekdays
- **d.** After final exams

2.

Listen to an announcement from the university library.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

63. What can visitors do at the event?

- **a.** Purchase artwork from the student gallery
- **b.** Enroll in upcoming studio courses
- **c.** Bring light refreshments
- **d.** Meet student artists

64. What is said about the event's location?

- **a.** It will be hosted online.
- **b.** It will be held outdoors near the library.
- **c.** It will take place in the Fine Arts Building.
- **d.** It will occur in the open studio.

3.

Listen to an announcement at a university event.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

65. What will the officers demonstrate during the session?

- **a.** Emergency response training and safety precautions
- **b.** Self-defense techniques and safety strategies
- **c.** How to contact the security hotline and find safe spaces on campus
- **d.** The process for reporting items lost or stolen

66. What does the speaker say participants will receive?

- **a.** A personal safety guide
- **b.** Free safety gear
- **c.** Extra credit in health and wellness courses
- **d.** Access to a private training session

4.

Listen to an announcement at a university event.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

67. What is the main purpose of the announcement?

- **a.** To announce new requirements for grant applications
- **b.** To inform students about a financial aid information session
- **c.** To advertise a workshop on budget management
- **d.** To remind students to check their financial aid status

68. Why does the speaker mention Friday at 10 a.m.?

- **a.** To specify the time and date of the information session
- **b.** To clarify the deadline for submitting financial forms
- **c.** To announce when financial aid offices will close
- **d.** To remind students about weekly office hours

5.

Listen to an announcement at a campus event.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

69. What are students encouraged to bring?

- **a.** A ticket purchased in advance
- **b.** Their university ID for free admission
- **c.** A printed schedule of the film lineup
- **d.** A short film created by media studies students

70. Why does the speaker mention the Q&A session?

- **a.** To explain how the films were selected
- **b.** To highlight that students can interact with the directors
- **c.** To promote volunteer opportunities at the theater
- **d.** To remind attendees to arrive early for seating

6.

Listen to an announcement at a university event.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

71. What is the main purpose of the announcement?

- **a.** To announce a change in how to format resumes
- **b.** To advertise internship openings
- **c.** To introduce a new career counselor
- **d.** To share information about a writing workshop

72. What should students bring to the event?

- **a.** A printed copy of their resume
- **b.** A laptop for writing practice
- **c.** Proof of registration
- **d.** A list of internship preferences

7.

Listen to an announcement at a university club meeting.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

73. When must members submit their work?

- **a.** On Wednesday afternoon before the reception
- **b.** By Tuesday at noon before the exhibition
- **c.** At the gallery on Friday morning
- **d.** During the opening event in the evening

74. Why does the speaker mention that frames and labels will be provided?

- **a.** To explain that entries must follow strict size requirements to exhibit work
- **b.** To let members know they don't need to bring their own materials
- **c.** To thank the art department for donating supplies provided on the site
- **d.** To remind students to label their photos carefully before submitting

8.

Listen to an announcement at a university club meeting.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

75. What is the main purpose of the announcement?

- **a.** To announce a change in meeting location for the club mixer
- **b.** To invite people to an upcoming mixer
- **c.** To report on last semester's events in the International Lounge
- **d.** To advertise a new language course for international students

76. What are students encouraged to do?

- **a.** Register early through the club website
- **b.** Prepare a short presentation about their country
- **c.** Bring a friend who might want to join the club
- **d.** Bring their own snacks to share with others

9.

Listen to an announcement at a university club meeting.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

77. What are participants encouraged to bring?

- **a.** Gardening tools from home
- **b.** Clothes suitable for getting dirty
- **c.** Bottles of water and snacks
- **d.** Extra pairs of gloves

78. What will volunteers be doing during the event?

- **a.** Painting the exterior of the greenhouse
- **b.** Building new tables for the garden
- **c.** Planting herbs and cleaning the greenhouse
- **d.** Cleaning up the local botanical garden

10.

Listen to an announcement at a housing meeting.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

79. What is the main purpose of the announcement?

- **a.** To remind residents about upcoming room checks for cleanliness
- **b.** To inform residents about a scheduled maintenance inspection
- **c.** To announce that heating systems will be replaced this week
- **d.** To warn residents about possible power outages

80. What are residents asked to do?

- **a.** Report maintenance issues to the front desk
- **b.** Turn off their heating systems in advance
- **c.** Keep their rooms accessible during the inspection
- **d.** Vacate their rooms for the morning

11.

Listen to an announcement at a campus event.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

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81. What is the main purpose of the announcement?

- **a.** To announce new courses offered by the Philosophy Department
- **b.** To summarize a recent study on artificial intelligence
- **c.** To invite students to attend a guest lecture
- **d.** To remind students about a midterm in ethics

82. What are students encouraged to do?

- **a.** Sign up online to reserve their seats
- **b.** Submit questions to the department beforehand
- **c.** Arrive early since seating is limited
- **d.** Read assigned articles before attending

12.

Listen to an announcement at a campus event.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

83. What is the main purpose of the announcement?

- **a.** To describe recent improvements to campus recycling bins
- **b.** To announce a new environmental studies course
- **c.** To recruit study groups to volunteer to share their projects
- **d.** To remind students about the upcoming fair

84. What kind of groups will be featured at the fair?

- **a.** Art clubs displaying sustainable sculptures
- **b.** Local businesses promoting clean energy
- **c.** Student organizations focused on environmental topics
- **d.** Campus departments offering internship programs

1.

Listen to a talk in a history class.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

85. According to the talk, how did the Green Revolution affect global trade?

- **a.** It enabled some nations to shift from importing to exporting food crops.
- **b.** It reduced the overall amount of grain available for international markets.
- **c.** It created trade conflicts between developing and industrialized countries over fertilizer use.
- **d.** It encouraged governments to ban the export of genetically modified seeds.

86. Why does the speaker mention India and Mexico?

- **a.** To highlight places where fertilizers and pesticides most impacted the population's health
- **b.** To compare regions that depended on imports for survival
- **c.** To illustrate countries where innovation increased food production
- **d.** To show where farming diversity has been replaced with innovative technology

87. According to the talk, what was one major drawback of the Green Revolution?

- **a.** It failed to improve overall grain yields in developing regions.
- **b.** It widened economic gaps between large commercial farms and smaller producers.
- **c.** It encouraged countries to abandon traditional irrigation and crop systems.
- **d.** It caused environmental damage through heavy use of fertilizers and pesticides.

88. What does the speaker imply about the long-term results of the Green Revolution?

- **a.** It solved food shortages but created new environmental challenges.
- **b.** It ended economic inequality among farmers in poorer nations.
- **c.** It prevented the use of modern irrigation systems that are better for the environment.
- **d.** It had no significant effect on global trade until the latter half of the 20th century.

2.

Listen to a talk in a psychology class.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

89. What is the main topic of the talk?

- **a.** The role of attention and focus in modern productivity methods
- **b.** A psychological phenomenon related to unfinished tasks
- **c.** How memory retention varies between short-term and long-term recall
- **d.** Early twentieth-century experiments that shaped the field of cognitive science

90. According to the speaker, what did Zeigarnik observe about waiters in a cafe?

- **a.** They performed better when they tracked multiple tables simultaneously.
- **b.** They remembered unpaid orders better than completed ones.
- **c.** They relied on repetition rather than reasoning to recall customer requests.
- **d.** They retained details longer when the café was quiet and less crowded.

91. What can be inferred about unfinished tasks according to the speaker?

- **a.** They are more memorable because people consciously choose to revisit them.
- **b.** They often strengthen unrelated cognitive skills.
- **c.** They tend to occupy the mind until they are completed.
- **d.** They typically cause the brain to block other incoming information.

92. What will the speaker most likely discuss next?

- **a.** Modern tools and techniques designed to help people stay focused
- **b.** The origins of psychological research in early twentieth-century Europe
- **c.** The relationship between memory and physical health in older adults
- **d.** The use of experimental methods in unrelated areas of psychology

3.

Listen to a talk in an anthropology class.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

93. What is the main topic of the talk?

- **a.** The effects of digital technology on modern societies
- **b.** The invention of mechanical clocks in Europe and its impact on culture
- **c.** How religion shaped early calendars and cultures
- **d.** The evolution of time measurement and its cultural significance

94. What can be inferred about the social function of timekeeping systems?

- **a.** They have little influence on human behavior
- **b.** They are developed mainly for religious control
- **c.** They reveal the cultural values and priorities of a society
- **d.** They remain unchanged despite technological progress

95. Why does the speaker mention the ringing of bells in medieval towns?

- **a.** To compare medieval time structure to the modern digital age
- **b.** To show how they organized people's daily lives
- **c.** To describe an early form of communication between towns
- **d.** To explain why clock towers became symbols of wealth

96. According to the speaker, what change did mechanical clocks bring to society?

- **a.** They reduced the need for written records of time.
- **b.** They replaced religious calendars and ceremonies.
- **c.** They ended the use of natural rhythms for agricultural production.
- **d.** They helped organize daily routines and emphasized punctuality.

4.

Listen to a talk in a physics class.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

97. What is the main topic of the talk?

- **a.** How animals survive cold temperatures through hibernation
- **b.** How water can remain liquid below its normal freezing point
- **c.** Why most liquids freeze at the same temperature
- **d.** How understanding the way ice forms leads to scientific breakthroughs

98. What does the speaker say about the wood frog?

- **a.** It survives winter by preventing ice from forming in vital organs.
- **b.** It keeps its body temperature above freezing by generating heat.
- **c.** It moves underground to escape extreme cold.
- **d.** It breathes through its skin while frozen.

99. What can be inferred about scientists' interest in studying supercooling?

- **a.** They believe that supercooling has limited practical applications.
- **b.** They are primarily focused on protecting animals from extreme cold.
- **c.** They are trying to develop new methods to heat frozen environments.
- **d.** They hope to apply natural freezing strategies to medical storage.

100. Why does the speaker describe the wood frog in detail?

- **a.** To show how certain species avoid water loss
- **b.** To compare animal hibernation with freezing
- **c.** To illustrate how supercooling functions in a living organism
- **d.** To explain why frogs are found in colder climates

5.

Listen to a talk in an environmental science class.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

101. What is the main topic of the talk?

- **a.** How weather patterns change in different parts of the world due to evaporation
- **b.** How evaporation functions and impacts society
- **c.** How evaporation helped humans adapt to extreme heat
- **d.** How scientists developed electric refrigeration systems based on evaporation

102. What does the speaker say about desert plants?

- **a.** They rely on wind to distribute moisture through their leaves and roots.
- **b.** They store large amounts of water to maintain growth during the day.
- **c.** They release moisture only at night to conserve water and regulate temperature.
- **d.** They open their pores during the day to collect sunlight more efficiently.

103. What can be inferred about evaporation's importance in engineering?

- **a.** It has replaced electricity in most modern appliances because of its cooling properties.
- **b.** It is primarily used to generate heat for large industrial machines.
- **c.** It provides a natural model for designing efficient cooling technologies.
- **d.** It is useful in humid environments with high water content.

104. Why does the speaker compare sweating to evaporation in the atmosphere?

- **a.** To explain why weather changes can affect body temperature
- **b.** To contrast the ways natural and human processes release energy
- **c.** To argue that evaporation works differently in living organisms
- **d.** To show that the same physical principle operates at both small and global scales

6.

Listen to a talk in an economics class.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

105. According to the talk, what is the opportunity cost for a student who chooses to work part-time?

- **a.** The academic improvement they might have gained instead
- **b.** The wages lost from not working extra shifts
- **c.** The experience of balancing multiple commitments
- **d.** The increased expenses that come with employment

106. All of the following are mentioned as examples of opportunity cost EXCEPT:

- **a.** Choosing to spend money on advertising instead of research
- **b.** Deciding between studying or working part-time as a student
- **c.** Investing public funds in space exploration instead of education
- **d.** Allocating money on a new product line instead of marketing

107. Why does the speaker mention the student deciding whether to work part-time?

- **a.** To argue that part-time jobs are just as valuable as unpaid internships
- **b.** To show an example that emphasizes a focus on academic success
- **c.** To demonstrate how education leads to financial independence
- **d.** To provide a relatable example of opportunity cost in everyday life

108. What will the speaker most likely discuss next?

- **a.** How scientists calculated the total expenses of building a spacecraft.
- **b.** How private companies used opportunity cost to fund early rocket design.
- **c.** How the U.S. government debated the costs of the space race.
- **d.** How public opinion changed about technology and education in the 1970s.

7.

Listen to a talk in a history class.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

109. What is the main focus of the talk?

- **a.** How skilled laborers designed the Great Pyramid
- **b.** How the materials for the Great Pyramid were meant to symbolize order
- **c.** How the construction of the Great Pyramid reflected Egypt's beliefs
- **d.** How modern engineers restored the Great Pyramid to its original state

110. According to the talk, how were the pyramid's limestone blocks transported?

- **a.** They were rolled downhill from distant mountains.
- **b.** They were dragged across desert sands using wooden sleds.
- **c.** They were lifted onto carriages that were pulled by animals.
- **d.** They were carried by boat along the Nile from nearby quarries.

111. What can be inferred about the significance of the Great Pyramid to the Egyptians?

- **a.** It served mainly as a defensive structure against invaders.
- **b.** It symbolized both political authority and spiritual connection.
- **c.** It demonstrated the growing influence of trade with foreign nations.
- **d.** It represented the rise of centralized royal power across North Africa.

112. Why does the speaker mention modern engineers?

- **a.** To suggest that ancient tools were less accurate than believed
- **b.** To explain how technology has simplified large-scale construction
- **c.** To compare ancient building methods with industrial techniques
- **d.** To show that the pyramid's precision still puzzles experts today

8.

Listen to a talk in a sociology class.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

113. What example does the speaker use to illustrate the concept of the looking-glass self?

- **a.** A musician receiving applause after a concert
- **b.** A manager evaluating an employee during a performance review
- **c.** A parent teaching a child to behave politely at dinner
- **d.** A student imagining classmates' reactions during a class presentation

114. All of the following are mentioned as outcomes of imagined social reflection EXCEPT:

- **a.** An emotional experience of embarrassment
- **b.** Heightened anxiety
- **c.** The rejection of all outside opinions
- **d.** Improved confidence

115. What can be inferred about the role of feedback in shaping identity?

- **a.** It reinforces or challenges how individuals see themselves.
- **b.** It weakens personal confidence by creating constant comparison.
- **c.** It has little effect on people who are already self-aware.
- **d.** It primarily influences professional rather than personal growth.

116. Why does the speaker mention social media?

- **a.** To contrast virtual communication with traditional forms of identity-building
- **b.** To argue that online feedback is less important than face-to-face interaction
- **c.** To show how modern technology increases opportunities for social reflection
- **d.** To explain why digital communication discourages self-evaluation

9.

Listen to a talk in an art history class.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

117. According to the talk, what was one benefit of using concrete in Roman architecture?

- **a.** It limited the need for decorative elements.
- **b.** It reduced the overall cost of building materials.
- **c.** It allowed the creation of larger and more durable structures.
- **d.** It replaced the use of stone in all construction projects.

118. What does the speaker imply about Roman building techniques?

- **a.** They were mainly copied from Greek designs.
- **b.** They combined functionality with artistic vision.
- **c.** They prioritized decoration over structural strength.
- **d.** They declined rapidly after the fall of the empire.

119. Why does the speaker mention the Colosseum and the Pantheon?

- **a.** To compare ancient theaters to modern sports arenas
- **b.** To provide examples that demonstrate Roman engineering skill
- **c.** To explain how Roman art differed from Greek art
- **d.** To describe why many Roman buildings were eventually destroyed

120. What will the speaker most likely discuss next?

- **a.** The religious symbolism of ancient Roman temples
- **b.** The political history of the Roman Empire's expansion
- **c.** The influence of Roman architectural methods
- **d.** The decline of Roman art and sculpture in the Middle Ages

10.

Listen to a talk in a sociology class.



NOTE TO STUDENT:

Do NOT look at the questions on the next page until after you listen. You may use a pencil and a piece of paper to take notes.

121. What is the main topic of the talk?

- **a.** The history of ecological theory and its impact on communities
- **b.** The decline of traditional fishing communities in coastal villages
- **c.** Modern debates about environmental regulation in fishing and pollution
- **d.** The overuse of shared resources and possible solutions

122. What can be inferred about effective resource management?

- **a.** It often depends on cooperation and shared responsibility among users.
- **b.** It requires the elimination of individual incentives to grow.
- **c.** It can succeed through strict government control.
- **d.** It is rarely influenced by local community traditions.

123. Why does the speaker include the story about herders and a shared pasture?

- **a.** To illustrate how individual actions can ruin a shared resource
- **b.** To describe ancient farming practices in rural societies
- **c.** To argue that cooperation among farmers is impossible without intervention
- **d.** To show how trade disputes once caused environmental decline

124. According to the talk, how have some communities responded to the tragedy of the commons?

- **a.** By abandoning traditional livelihoods that depend on shared environments
- **b.** By creating shared management systems that limit the use of common resources
- **c.** By increasing government oversight to dissuade individuals from breaking the rules
- **d.** By switching entirely from local resources to imported alternatives

100 Practice Questions for the TOEFL® Listening Section

Answer Key

Listen and Choose

Set 1

1. A, *Yes, she answered all my questions after class.*
A is correct because it directly answers the question and provides relevant detail about what was discussed. The other responses fail to address the question or shift topics. Option d could fit, but a certainly fits, making a the better answer. Option d brings up the idea of checking a syllabus, and that is never mentioned or alluded to.

Did you get a chance to talk to the professor?

2. C, Most of the team was working from home.
C is correct because it logically explains why the office was quiet. The other options give unrelated or general information.

Why was the office so quiet this morning?

3. A, Dr. Lopez, the researcher from Argentina.
A is correct because it provides the name and background of the presenter, which fully answers the question. The remaining choices either mention unrelated facts or lack specificity.

Who's presenting in the next session?

4. D, *Barely, but I got a spot two blocks away*.
D is correct because it answers the question about parking and adds a realistic detail. The others are off-topic or lack a clear response.

Did you manage to find parking near the theater?

5. C, *It should heal completely if I rest for a week.*
C is correct because it relays the doctor's advice, directly addressing the question. The other options reference unrelated details about appointments or times.

What did the doctor say about your knee?

6. D, *We're visiting my cousins in Spain for two weeks.*
D is correct because it clearly states the vacation destination and length, directly answering the question. The others provide vague or unrelated information.

Where are you going for your vacation this year?

7. B, *Right after paying for coffee at the station.*
B is correct because it specifies the time and situation when the loss was noticed. The others mention unrelated details or avoid answering the question.

When did you realize you'd lost your wallet?

8. B, Finally, yes—it's working perfectly now.
B is correct because it confirms the elevator has been repaired and adds relevant detail. The other choices describe physical features or irrelevant facts.

Did they ever fix the elevator in your building?

9. D, Professor Adams from the physics department.
D is correct because it identifies who will give the lecture, directly addressing the question. The other options discuss location or logistics but not the person.

Who's giving the guest lecture on Friday?

10. B, The drop box is right by the entrance.
B is correct because it tells the listener exactly where to return the books. The others discuss due dates or unrelated information.

I'm not sure where to return these library books.

Set 2

11. A, *I hope it went well.*
A is correct because it's a polite and natural response to someone mentioning a dentist visit. The others are overly factual or off-topic.

I just got back from the dentist.

12. A, *No, it was delayed by an hour.*
A is correct because it answers the question about timing with clear information. The other options discuss unrelated details or misunderstand the question.

Isn't your train leaving any minute now?

13. B, *Yes, they'll check them at the gate.*
B is correct because it confirms the necessity of passports and adds a relevant detail. The other options discuss travel but do not fulfill the question's expectation.

Aren't we supposed to bring our passports?

14. B, *It was rescheduled for next week.*
B is correct because it provides updated information about the interview. The other responses introduce new details that don't fit the situation.

Didn't you mention an interview this morning?

15. D, *They decided to come next month instead.*
D is correct because it responds directly to the question about the parents' visit and provides a new timeframe. The others are incomplete or off-topic. Option A says "*his flight*" but the statement is about parents, so the pronoun is incorrect.

Aren't your parents visiting this weekend?

16. B, *I didn't realize it was that loud..*
B is correct because it addresses the request made to turn down the music. All of the other answers address the issue of the volume of the music, making option b the best answer.

Could you please turn down the volume?

17. D, *Marcus offered to take the lead this time.*
D is correct because it answers the question about who is taking the lead on the client presentation. The other options miss the point of the question, talking about the meeting location or the presentation itself, rather than on the person who will be delivering it.

Who's handling the client presentation tomorrow?

18. C, *Not at all, I just got here myself.*
C is correct because it politely reassures the speaker and fits the situation perfectly. The other responses are factual or slightly awkward.

I hope I didn't keep you waiting.

19. C, *Yes, I sent it to Career Services yesterday.*
C is correct because it confirms completion of the application and adds timing information. The others either lack clarity or don't address the question.

Did you already submit your internship application?

20. A, *Ms. Grant from the marketing department.*
A is correct because it directly identifies the person leading the meeting. The remaining options discuss timing or logistics instead of answering the question.

Who's leading the staff meeting this week?

Set 3

21. B, *No, but I've heard she's from Brazil.*
B is correct because it answers the question and adds context about the student. The others refer to the student indirectly or shift the focus.

Have you met the new exchange student?

22. A, *Yes, but they forgot one of my shirts.*
A is correct because it answers affirmatively and adds a relevant detail. The other options are grammatically awkward or unrelated.

Did you pick up your dry cleaning?

23. D, *That's okay, maybe next time.*
D is correct because it politely acknowledges the apology in a natural and socially appropriate way. The other options sound defensive or unrelated.

I'm sorry I couldn't make it to your party.

24. D, *Let's keep the volume low for now.*
D is correct because it pragmatically responds to the observation by suggesting an appropriate action. The other answers describe the situation but don't address it.

I think the neighbors are still asleep.

25. D, *Yes, until midnight for the next two weeks.*
D is correct because it confirms the library's extended hours and provides useful detail. The others fail to answer directly.

Isn't the library open later during exams?

26. A, *I did, but it broke in the wind.*
A is correct because it acknowledges having bought the umbrella and adds an explanatory detail. The other responses don't fully fit the question.

Didn't you just buy a new umbrella?

27. D, *Here, let me give it a try.*
D is correct because it responds helpfully to someone struggling with the jar, offering direct assistance. The others mention related objects but not the action requested.

I can't seem to open this jar.

28. B, *You can borrow my charger if you need it.*
B is correct because it offers a practical solution to the problem mentioned. The others discuss irrelevant details.

My laptop battery's almost dead.

29. A, *I'll drop them off on my way home.*
A is correct because it fulfills the speaker's request to post the letters by agreeing and specifying when. The other options describe but do not act.

Could you post these letters for me?

30. A, *Glad I could help.*
A is correct because it acknowledges appreciation in a friendly and natural way. The other options sound mechanical or unrelated.

I really appreciate your advice.

Listen to a Conversation

Conversation #1

31. C
The man says he will double-check their flight times "*so we can make sure we get to the rental car place on time*." This shows that he wants to confirm the schedule to avoid missing the pickup window. Option A is incorrect because there's no indication he plans to change the flight. Option B is wrong since he never mentions forgetting. Option D doesn't fit because he expresses concern about timing, not business hours.

32. A
The man suggests that the woman handle booking the rental car. He says, "*I'll cover the hotel if you handle the car*," clearly dividing the responsibilities. Option B is incorrect because they plan to rent ahead of time. Option C is wrong since he never asks her to contact the airline. Option D doesn't fit because he offers to pay for the hotel himself, not the other way around.

Conversation #1 Transcript

Man: I can't believe our trip is only two weeks away. Have you booked the rental car yet?
Woman: Not yet. I was comparing prices last night, and some companies offer better weekend rates if you prepay.
Man: That's good to know. I'll cover the hotel if you handle the car.
Woman: Deal. I'll finalize it tonight and send you the confirmation.
Man: Perfect. I'll double-check our flight times so we can make sure we get to the rental car place on time.
Woman: Sounds like a plan. Everything's coming together nicely.

Conversation #2

33. D
The man explains that he tried to move his appointment but found "*the only other time available is next week*." This directly answers why he can't reschedule for later in the day. Option A doesn't fit because the type of appointment isn't described as mandatory. Option B and C are both unrelated to what the man says.

34. C
The man says he will "*email him this afternoon*," referring to his supervisor, which indicates that his next step will be to send the message about the conflict. Option A is incorrect because the man intends to keep his appointment, not cancel it. Option B doesn't fit since he plans to attend both if possible. Option D is wrong because the woman never suggests asking for meeting notes.

Conversation #2 Transcript

Man: I just realized my doctor's appointment is at the same time as my team meeting tomorrow.
Woman: Can you move the appointment to later in the day?
Man: I checked online, but the only other time available is next week.
Woman: I see. Maybe let your supervisor know. If the meeting isn't critical, you might be able to join after your appointment.
Man: That could work. I'll email him this afternoon.
Woman: You might want to do that now before it gets too late. You know he doesn't like last-minute surprises.

Conversation #3

35. C
The man states that he'll "*resend the calendar invite with the new time and link*." This shows he agrees to update and send out the revised meeting invitation. Option A is wrong because there's no mention of printing. Option B is incorrect since the woman is the one who will message the client. Option D doesn't fit because he doesn't plan to find another room.

36. A
The woman's reaction, "*Oh no, not again*," implies that scheduling conflicts have happened before. This suggests that double-bookings are a recurring problem. Option B is incorrect because the company clearly hosts client meetings. Option C and D are unrelated to the dialogue.

Conversation #3 Transcript

Man: I have a quick update. The room we reserved for the client meeting got double-booked.
Woman: Oh no, not again. What's the plan?
Man: I can move the meeting back half an hour and switch it to an online call. That should give us time to adjust.
Woman: Works for me. I'll message the client so they're not waiting downstairs.
Man: I'll resend the calendar invite with the new time and link.
Woman: Thanks. While you're at it, please attach the revised agenda too.

Conversation #4

37. B
The woman says she lost her ID "*during the field trip last week*," which directly identifies where the loss occurred. Option A is incorrect because she only borrowed a temporary pass from the library. Options C and D are never mentioned.

38. D
The man tells her that she can get a new ID at the student center and that "*they print replacements on the spot*." This means she can receive it immediately. Option A is wrong because he says the opposite. Option B describes her current situation, not the replacement process. Option C is incorrect because he doesn't mention any online form.

Conversation #4 Transcript

Man: Did you ever get your student ID replaced?
Woman: Not yet. I lost it during the field trip last week, and I've been borrowing the temporary pass from the library.
Man: You can get a new one at the student center. They print replacements on the spot.
Woman: Great. I'll stop by this afternoon before my next class.

Conversation #5

39. D
The man finds his keys when he checks his jacket pocket, confirming that's where he left them. The other locations are all suggested earlier in the conversation but ruled out as he searches.

40. A
The conversation shows that the man often loses small items. The woman even says, "*You really should hang them by the door like I keep telling you*," implying this is a recurring habit. None of the other options are supported by the dialogue.

Conversation #5 Transcript

Man: Have you seen my car keys anywhere?
Woman: Weren't they on the kitchen table?
Man: Not anymore. I've checked every drawer and the counter.
Woman: Did you wear your jacket yesterday? You always leave them in the pocket.
Man: Oh, good call…Wait a second… Yep, here they are.
Woman: You really should hang them by the door like I keep telling you.
Man: I know, I know. I will.

Conversation #6

41. B
The woman says she'll "*grab those seats before the price goes up*," making it clear she wants to book quickly to avoid higher fares. Option A is inaccurate because she's already aware the early trains are full. Option C doesn't fit since the trip is confirmed, and option D isn't mentioned.

42. C
At the end of the conversation, the man says, *"Let me know if I owe you anything*," which means he's asking how much he should pay her for the tickets. The other choices misinterpret his request.

Conversation #6 Transcript

Man: Did you end up booking the train tickets for next weekend?
Woman: Not yet. I checked this morning, but the earlier trains were already full. The only ones left were in the afternoon, and I wasn't sure if you wanted to leave that late since it would mean arriving after dinner.
Man: That's fine. I'd rather travel later than rush in the morning.
Woman: Okay, I'll grab those seats before the price goes up.
Man: Perfect. Let me know if I owe you anything.

Conversation #7

43. C
The woman says, "*You probably left it at the restaurant last night*," identifying the likely place where the umbrella was forgotten. Options A, B, and D don't reflect what she says.

44. A
The woman suggests calling the restaurant because "*they usually keep lost items at the front desk*." This implies the staff might still have the umbrella. Option B is unrelated, and C and D add information not mentioned in the exchange.

Conversation #7 Transcript

Man: I can't find my umbrella anywhere. Did I leave it in your car?
Woman: I don't think so. You probably left it at the restaurant last night.
Man: Oh, you're right. I put it under the table and forgot to grab it when we left.
Woman: Maybe someone turned it in.
Man: I'll call them after work and check.
Woman: Good idea. They usually keep lost items at the front desk.

Conversation #8

45. D
The man offers to pick up the cake because he "*will be driving past the bakery anyway*." His reasoning is purely practical. The other options are unrelated to what he says.

46. A
The woman tells the man, "*Just make sure they spell her name right this time*," reminding him to double-check the writing on the cake. The other answers introduce details not mentioned in the conversation.

Conversation #8 Transcript

Man: Is everything ready for the birthday party tomorrow?
Woman: Almost. The decorations are done, but I still need to pick up the cake in the morning.
Man: Do you want me to handle that? I'll be driving past the bakery anyway.
Woman: That would be great. Just make sure they spell her name right this time.

Conversation #9

47. D
The man says he plans to rent a bike and "*explore the riverside trail*," which directly answers the question. The other locations are not mentioned.

48. C
The woman advises him to bring water and sunscreen *"because parts of the trail don't have much shade*." This means she's thinking about protection from the sun. The other choices are unrelated to her reasoning.

Conversation #9 Transcript

Man: I'm thinking about renting a bike this weekend and exploring the riverside trail.
Woman: That sounds like a great idea. Have you biked there before?
Man: Not yet, but I've heard it's beautiful, especially around sunset.
Woman: Just make sure to bring some water and sunscreen. Parts of the trail don't have much shade.
Man: Thanks, I'll keep that in mind. Want to come along?
Woman: Maybe. It's been a while since I've been on a bike.

Conversation #10

49. A
The man says he's already "*left polite notes*" for the neighbors, which is the action he's taken so far. None of the other answers reflect the conversation.

50. A
The woman advises, "*Do it today before it happens again this weekend*," referring to contacting the building manager. She encourages him to act soon rather than wait. Options B, C, and D are all inconsistent with her advice.

Conversation #10 Transcript

Man: The neighbors upstairs were playing music until after midnight again. I barely slept.
Woman: Maybe you could start leave a polite note under their door. Sometimes people don't realize how loud they're being.
Man: I've already done that twice. It helped for a few days, then the noise came back.
Woman: I guess you could talk to the building manager. They can remind them about quiet hours.
Man: At this point, that's probably the best option.
Woman: Do it today before it happens again this weekend.

Conversation #11

51. A
The woman mentions that "*the instructor's great with beginners*," showing that the teacher is skilled at helping newcomers. The other options misrepresent what she says.

52. D
At the end of the conversation, the man agrees to attend, saying, "*All right, I'll give it a try*." This confirms that he plans to go to the free yoga class on Saturday. The other options are never mentioned.

Conversation #11 Transcript

Woman: My friend keeps telling me to try that new yoga studio near the park.
Man: I've seen it. The space looks nice from the outside.
Woman: She said the instructor's great with beginners and the classes aren't too crowded.
Man: That's good to know. I've been meaning to work on my flexibility anyway.
Woman: You should come with me Saturday morning. They're offering the first class free.
Man: All right, I'll give it a try.

Conversation #12

53. C
The man praises the sushi place, saying "*the fish was really fresh, and the service was quick*." This matches option C exactly. The other options either distort or omit key details.

54. A
The woman says, "*Thanks for the tip. I'll call them this afternoo*n," showing she plans to make a reservation. The other options don't reflect what she says.

Conversation #12 Transcript

Man: Have you tried that new sushi place on Maple Avenue yet?
Woman: Not yet. Is it any good?
Man: I went last weekend, and it was better than I expected. The fish was really fresh, and the service was quick.
Woman: That's great to hear. I might go tomorrow night.
Man: Just make a reservation. It gets crowded around dinner time.
Woman: Thanks for the tip. I'll call them this afternoon.

Conversation #13

55. B
The woman asks if the man mentioned it was a birthday celebration, and he replies that the restaurant is adding a dessert "*on the house*." Together, these lines confirm the dinner is for a birthday. The other options describe unrelated occasions.

56. A
The man mentions the free dessert to show that the restaurant is offering it as a complimentary gesture. He's simply sharing that bit of good news, not trying to influence their plans.

Conversation #13 Transcript

Woman: Did you confirm the dinner reservation for tonight?
Man: Yes, we're all set for seven o'clock. They said they'll hold the table for fifteen minutes.
Woman: Perfect. Did you mention it's a birthday celebration?
Man: I did. They're adding a dessert on the house.
Woman: That's nice of them. I'll bring the card and gift bag.

Conversation #14

57. A
When the man says, "*Worst case, we'll grab dessert somewhere else afterward*," he's showing flexibility about the evening, not changing the restaurant choice. Option A captures that meaning best.

58. D
The woman notes that some people complain about the service, but "*it might just depend on who's working that night*." This suggests that the quality of service varies, which aligns with option D.

Conversation #14 Transcript

Woman: What do you want to do for dinner tonight?
Man: I was thinking of trying that new Thai restaurant on Main Street.
Woman: I've heard mixed reviews. Some people say the curry's amazing, but others complained about the service. Still, it might just depend on who's working that night.
Man: I don't mind giving it a shot. Worst case, we'll grab dessert somewhere else afterward.
Woman: Fair enough. Let's aim for seven, then.

Conversation #15

59. B
The woman advises the man to email his advisor now "*to ask if she can meet a little later*," which means he's requesting a new appointment time. Options A and C are off-topic, and D doesn't relate to the problem.

60. A
The man says, "*I still need her signature for my scholarship form before the deadline*," which clearly states what he needs from his advisor. None of the other choices fit the context.

Conversation #15 Transcript

Man: I just realized my advising appointment overlaps with my economics class this afternoon.
Woman: If you ask your advisor, she might be able to meet a little later. I think she stays in the office until 5 p.m.
Man: That would be great. I still need her signature for my scholarship form before the deadline.
Woman: Send her an email now. If she agrees, then there won't be a problem.
Man: Okay. I'll send her a message right away.

Announcement #1

61. D
The announcement informs students about new library hours, specifically noting that the library will stay open until midnight on weekdays. None of the other options match the focus of the message. The speaker doesn't promote general services, remind students to return books, or introduce a new reservation system.

62. A
The new hours will begin next Monday. The announcement clearly states that this change will start then, giving students time to prepare for finals. The other choices either refer to the wrong day or misinterpret "*midnight on weekdays*" as the start time rather than part of the schedule.

Announcement #1 Transcript

Listen to an announcement from the university library.

Hi everyone. Starting next Monday, the library will remain open until midnight on weekdays to help you prepare for final exams. Study rooms can be reserved online up to two days in advance. We hope these extended hours make studying a little easier for everyone.

Announcement #2

63. D
Visitors can meet student artists during the Art Department's Open Studio Night. The speaker directly mentions this as one of the key activities at the event. The other options are not supported—there's no mention of selling artwork, enrolling in classes, or bringing food.

64. C
The event will take place in the Fine Arts Building. This is stated explicitly in the announcement. The other choices refer to outdoor or online locations that are not mentioned.

Announcement #2 Transcript

Listen to an announcement from the university library.

Good afternoon, everyone. The Art Department invites you to its annual Open Studio Night this Friday from 5 to 8 p.m. in the Fine Arts Building. Visitors can meet student artists, explore their creative spaces, and see new works in progress. Light refreshments will be served, and admission is free.

Announcement #3

65. B
The officers will demonstrate self-defense techniques and share safety tips. The speaker outlines these demonstrations as the main focus of the workshop. The other options refer to activities not included in the announcement, such as emergency response training or reporting lost items.

66. A
Participants will receive a personal safety guide after the presentation. This is stated clearly at the end of the announcement. The other options are incorrect because there's no mention of free equipment, extra credit, or additional training sessions.

Announcement #3 Transcript

Listen to an announcement at a university event.

Good afternoon. The Office of Campus Safety is hosting a workshop next Wednesday at 2 p.m. in Room 109 of the Student Center. Officers will demonstrate self-defense techniques and share tips for staying safe when walking at night or using public transportation. The session is free, and participants will receive a personal safety guide after the presentation.

Announcement #4

67. B
The announcement is meant to inform students about the financial aid information session. The speaker states the date, time, and purpose—to help students with renewals and scholarships. The other options are unrelated to the actual content of the session.

68. A
Friday at 10 a.m. is mentioned to identify when and where the information session will occur. It is not a deadline or office hour reference. The other options suggest unrelated times or administrative purposes.

Announcement #4 Transcript

Listen to an announcement at a university event.

Good morning, students. The Financial Aid Office will host an information session this Friday at 10 a.m. in Room 202. Staff members will explain how to complete renewal applications and answer questions about scholarships and grants for next year. Students are encouraged to bring their laptops if they want help submitting forms online.

Announcement #5

69. B
Students are encouraged to bring their university ID for free admission. The announcement explains that admission is free for students who show their ID, while the other choices either add incorrect requirements or suggest unrelated items.

70. B
The Q&A session is mentioned to highlight that students can interact with the directors. This detail encourages engagement and shows added value for attendees. The other options misrepresent the purpose of the session or its timing.

Announcement #5 Transcript

Listen to an announcement at a campus event.

Before we wrap up, a quick reminder that the annual Student Film Festival begins this Friday evening in the Humanities Theater. Short films created by media studies students will be shown throughout the weekend, followed by a Q&A session with the directors. Admission is free for all students with a university ID.

Announcement #6

71. D
The announcement's purpose is to share information about a resume-writing workshop. The speaker describes when and where it will occur and what students will learn. The other options are unrelated to what the event actually offers.

72. A
Students should bring a printed copy of their resume. The announcement makes this request explicitly. The other options introduce requirements not mentioned, such as laptops or registration proof.

Announcement #6 Transcript

Listen to an announcement at a university event.

The Career Center is offering a short resume-writing workshop this Friday at 2 p.m. in Room 118. Students will learn how to highlight experience and tailor applications for internships. No registration is required. Please just bring a printed copy of your resume for feedback.

Announcement #7

73. B
Members must submit their work by Tuesday at noon before the exhibition. The speaker gives this precise submission deadline. The other choices are wrong because they refer to different times or dates.

74. B
The speaker mentions that frames and labels will be provided to let members know they don't need to bring their own materials. The other options incorrectly interpret this as a rule, a thank-you, or a reminder about labeling.

Announcement #7 Transcript

Listen to an announcement at a university club meeting.

Good afternoon, members. Our club exhibition, Through the Lens, will open next Friday in the Student Gallery. Each member can submit up to three printed photographs by Tuesday at noon. Frames and labels will be provided on-site. Friends and faculty are welcome to attend the opening reception starting at 6 p.m.

Announcement #8

75. B
The purpose of the announcement is to invite people to the upcoming Language Exchange Club mixer. The event details, such as location and activities, confirm this. The other options suggest unrelated topics or past events.

76. C
Students are encouraged to bring a friend who might want to join. The speaker specifically mentions this at the end of the announcement. The other choices involve unrelated activities like giving presentations or registering online.

Announcement #8 Transcript

Listen to an announcement at a university club meeting.

Hi everyone. The Language Exchange Club will host its first mixer of the semester next Wednesday evening in the International Lounge. It's a casual event where you can meet international students and practice different languages. Light snacks will be served, and we'll have conversation cards to help start discussions. Feel free to bring a friend who's interested in joining.

Announcement #9

77. B
Participants are encouraged to wear clothes suitable for getting dirty. The speaker explicitly tells volunteers to "*wear clothes you don't mind getting dirty*." The other options, such as bringing gloves or snacks, are not emphasized as requirements.

78. C
Volunteers will be planting herbs and cleaning the greenhouse area. This is mentioned directly as the focus of the event. The other options suggest unrelated activities, like painting or working outside the campus garden.

Announcement #9 Transcript

Listen to an announcement at a university club meeting.

Just a reminder that our campus garden volunteer day is this Saturday from 9 a.m. to noon. We'll be planting herbs and cleaning up the greenhouse area. Tools and gloves will be provided, but please wear clothes you don't mind getting dirty.

Announcement #10

79. B
The announcement's main purpose is to inform residents about a scheduled maintenance inspection. The speaker explains when and where maintenance will occur. The other options suggest unrelated reasons such as replacements or outages.

80. C
Residents are asked to keep their rooms accessible during the inspection. This request appears clearly near the end of the message. The other options mention actions not required in the announcement.

Announcement #10 Transcript

Listen to an announcement at a housing meeting.

Hello residents, this is a message from the Housing Office. Tomorrow morning between 9 and 11 a.m., maintenance staff will inspect the heating systems on the third and fourth floors of West Hall. Please make sure your rooms are accessible during that time. Thank you for your cooperation and understanding.

Announcement #11

81. C
The purpose of the announcement is to invite students to attend a guest lecture. The details—speaker, topic, time, and location—support this interpretation. The other options are unrelated or focus on different activities.

82.C
Students are encouraged to arrive early because seats are limited. The announcement warns listeners to come early to ensure they can attend. The other options, such as reserving seats or reading beforehand, are never mentioned.

Announcement #11 Transcript

Listen to an announcement at a campus event.

Good afternoon, everyone. The Department of Philosophy is hosting a guest lecture next Monday at 3 p.m. in the Main Auditorium. Dr. Alicia Morgan, a leading researcher in digital ethics, will discuss how artificial intelligence is changing privacy and communication. The talk is open to all students, and questions will be taken at the end. Seats are limited, so please arrive early.

Announcement #12

83. D
The announcement reminds students about the upcoming Campus Sustainability Fair. The speaker states when and where it will be held, making it clear the goal is to remind listeners, not introduce a new program. The other choices describe unrelated activities.

84.C
The groups featured at the fair are student organizations focused on environmental topics. The announcement says that student and local groups will share projects related to recycling and clean energy. The other choices mention art, business, or internships, none of which are part of the event.

Announcement #12 Transcript

Listen to an announcement at a campus event.

Before we end, here's a quick reminder about the Campus Sustainability Fair happening this Thursday from 10 a.m. to 4 p.m. in the university courtyard. Over twenty student groups and local organizations will share projects related to recycling, clean energy, and environmental design. Feel free to stop by anytime.

Listen to an Academic Talk #1

85. A
The lecture explains that higher yields allowed some countries to move from dependence on imports to selling surplus grain abroad. Options B and D invent outcomes not discussed. Option C narrows the issue to fertilizer disputes, which the speaker never raises as a trade driver.

86. C
India and Mexico are cited as concrete cases where new crop varieties, irrigation, and fertilizers boosted harvests. Option A distorts the example into a health focus, and B mislabels them as import dependent in the passage. Option D confuses yield gains with a claim about replacing diversity through technology at those specific sites.

87. D
The talk explicitly notes soil degradation and water pollution from heavy chemical use as a major downside. Option B is partially related but not the stated "*major drawback*." Options A and C contradict the passage, which reports big yield gains and does not say irrigation traditions were abandoned.

88. A
The speaker frames the legacy as solving hunger pressures while creating environmental problems that now demand sustainable approaches. Options B and C are opposite to the text. Option D ignores the passage's point that trade patterns changed during the period.

Listen to an Academic Talk #1 Transcript

Listen to a talk in a history class.

The Green Revolution refers to the period during the mid-twentieth century when dramatic increases in agricultural production transformed food systems around the world. It began with the development of high-yield crop varieties, particularly wheat and rice, combined with new irrigation methods and synthetic fertilizers. These innovations helped countries such as India and Mexico reduce famine and feed rapidly growing populations. In some regions, harvests doubled or even tripled within a decade. Yet these gains came with trade-offs. Reliance on chemical fertilizers and pesticides led to soil degradation and water pollution, while small farmers who couldn't afford new technologies were often left behind. Agricultural diversity also declined as a few high-yield species replaced traditional crops that had been cultivated for centuries.

The Green Revolution reshaped not only farming but also global economics and politics. Nations that once relied on food imports became exporters, altering trade relationships and patterns of rural migration. Today, agricultural scientists are reexamining its legacy as they search for ways to balance productivity with sustainability. Many researchers argue that a new kind of "green revolution" is needed—one that combines modern science with ecological farming practices. In upcoming discussions, we will consider how these efforts are addressing challenges like climate change, soil restoration, and equitable food distribution.

Listen to an Academic Talk #2

89. B
Everything centers on why unfinished tasks linger in memory and how that tension keeps goals active. Option A broadens the topic to attention generally. Options C and D miss the focus by shifting to memory systems or the history of the field.

90. B
Zeigarnik noticed waiters retained unpaid orders but quickly forgot settled ones, which launched the idea. Options A and D add performance and crowding claims that are absent. Option C invents a strategy the talk never mentions.

91. C
The implication is that incomplete goals keep the mind engaged until closure, so they continue to occupy attention. Option A overstates conscious choice. Options B and D describe effects the lecture does not claim.

92. A
The final sentence points forward to apps and methods that support focus, so the next topic is modern tools. The other options shift to unrelated periods or themes not queued by the transition.

Listen to an Academic Talk #2 Transcript

Listen to a talk in a psychology class.

The Zeigarnik Effect refers to the human tendency to remember unfinished tasks more vividly than completed ones. The concept originated in the 1920s when psychologist Bluma Zeigarnik noticed that waiters in a café recalled unpaid orders with remarkable accuracy but quickly forgot them once the bills were settled. She reasoned that incomplete tasks create a mild state of psychological tension that keeps them active in memory until closure is achieved.

Subsequent studies have supported this finding. In one experiment, participants who were interrupted midway through solving puzzles remembered the details better than those who finished without interruption. Their minds appeared to keep the unresolved task "open," as if waiting for completion. Modern researchers link this to goal-oriented cognition: when a goal remains incomplete, the brain maintains heightened focus on related information.

The Zeigarnik Effect helps explain why people replay unfinished conversations or feel compelled to check incomplete work. It also suggests practical strategies for productivity, such as breaking large projects into smaller segments that preserve motivation. Next, let's take a look at some popular apps and inventions that people use today to improve their focus and reduce the impact of the Zeigarnik Effect.

Listen to an Academic Talk #3

93. D
The professor traces timekeeping from celestial rhythms to mechanical clocks and into digital culture, stressing meaning and social effects. Options A, B, and C isolate one slice of that story and miss the broader arc.

94. C
The lecturer says time systems reveal what societies value, which means they reflect priorities and norms. Option A contradicts that claim. Options B and D overstate control or deny change, neither of which appears in the talk.

95. B
Bells are mentioned as the daily signal that organized work, worship, and routine, illustrating social coordination. Option A forces a comparison that the speaker does not make. Options C and D assign roles not supported by the passage.

96. D
Mechanical clocks are linked to punctuality and structured schedules, so organizing routines is the correct effect. The other options either remove functions or claim replacements the lecture does not describe.

Listen to an Academic Talk #3 Transcript

Listen to a talk in an anthropology class.

Across cultures, humans have long sought ways to measure and give meaning to the passage of time. Early agricultural societies relied on celestial patterns, like the rising sun or the phases of the moon, to guide planting and harvest. These rhythms became woven into religious ceremonies that marked renewal and transformation, linking time measurement with spiritual life.

As cities and trade networks expanded, timekeeping grew more precise and more social. Mechanical clocks appeared in medieval Europe, first in monasteries and later in public squares. The regular tolling of bells organized work, worship, and daily routine, signaling a shift toward a culture that valued punctuality and discipline. Over centuries, these practices shaped how people conceived of labor and progress.

Anthropologists studying timekeeping note that such systems reveal a society's priorities, including whether it values order and efficiency or connection and renewal. The contrast between linear and cyclical views of time continues to influence everything from business culture to personal identity. Scholars exploring this topic are now turning to how digital technologies are redefining our sense of time in the twenty-first century.

Listen to an Academic Talk #4

97. B
The central idea is how water can remain liquid below its normal freezing point and why that matters. Options A and C misframe the scope. Option D elevates applications to the main idea when they are a later implication.

98. A
The wood frog example shows protective substances prevent ice from forming in vital organs, allowing survival through freezing conditions. Options B and C propose strategies the talk never mentions. Option D introduces a physiological claim not stated.

99. D
From the final paragraph, researchers hope to apply these biological strategies to preserve organs, blood, and vaccines. Options A and C contradict the medical storage angle. Option B shifts the goal to animal protection, which is not the stated motivation.

100. C
The detailed account of the wood frog serves as a concrete illustration of supercooling at work in a living system. Options A, B, and D redirect the purpose to dehydration, hibernation comparison, or habitat range, none of which is the focus of that example.

Listen to an Academic Talk #4 Transcript

Listen to a talk in a physics class.

Under normal conditions, water freezes at zero degrees Celsius. But in some situations, it can stay liquid even when the temperature drops below that point. This unusual process is called supercooling. It happens when there is nothing in the water for ice to form around. Usually, small bits of dust or rough surfaces give the ice crystals a place to start growing. Without those, the water molecules keep moving freely, and the liquid does not turn into ice right away.

In nature, this ability can be a powerful survival tool. Some insects, fish, and frogs use supercooling to survive harsh winters. The wood frog is one of the most striking examples. During cold months, most of its body actually freezes, but special substances inside its cells stop ice from forming in the organs that matter most. Its heartbeat and breathing come to a complete stop, yet when the weather warms, the frog thaws and returns to life.

Scientists are interested in how these animals control freezing so precisely. If humans could copy their strategy, it might help store delicate materials like organs, blood, or vaccines for longer periods without damage. Studying supercooling reveals how living things adapt to extreme cold and how nature often solves problems that science is still trying to master.

Listen to an Academic Talk #5

101. B
The talk explains the physics of evaporation and shows how that principle shapes bodies, buildings, and weather systems. Options A and C narrow the topic to weather or heat adaptation alone. Option D misstates the role of refrigeration.

102. C
Desert plants are described as opening pores at night, releasing moisture while conserving water and regulating temperature. Options A and D misrepresent timing. Option B assumes large daytime storage as the key point, which the lecturer does not claim.

103. C
Evaporative cooling provides a model that engineers adapt into devices such as swamp coolers, so it informs efficient design. Option A exaggerates its reach. Options B and D contradict the described use and climate suitability.

104. D
The professor links sweating and atmospheric evaporation to show one principle at two scales, from the body to global weather. Options A, B, and C either mix causes or claim differences that the lecture does not make.

Listen to an Academic Talk #5 Transcript

Listen to a talk in an environmental science class.

We often think of sweating as an uncomfortable part of being hot, but it's actually one of the body's most efficient cooling systems. The process behind it, evaporation, has fascinated scientists for centuries and plays an important role far beyond human biology. When a liquid turns into vapor, it takes heat energy from its surroundings. This is why wet skin feels cooler when a breeze passes over it: energy leaves the surface as the water molecules escape into the air.

Engineers and biologists have both learned from this principle. In desert climates, some plants have evolved tiny pores that open only at night to release moisture, conserving water while still controlling temperature. People have applied similar logic to design evaporative cooling systems, sometimes called "swamp coolers," which chill indoor air using water instead of electricity-hungry refrigerators. These systems work best in dry areas, where evaporation happens quickly.

Evaporation also influences global weather. As ocean water evaporates, it adds moisture to the air that later falls as rain, driving the planet's water cycle. From our own sweat to vast atmospheric systems, the same principle connects life and climate. This simple exchange between liquid and vapor shows how an everyday process can control patterns far larger than ourselves, shaping both the weather above us and the conditions we live in.

Listen to an Academic Talk #6

105. A
Choosing to work part-time costs the student study time that could raise grades and open future opportunities, which the lecture frames as the true sacrifice. Option B confuses lost wages with the scenario's benefit rather than its cost. Option C is a side effect, not the forgone alternative of highest value. Option D invents expenses the speaker never mentions.

106. A
Spending on advertising instead of research is never given as an example. The talk clearly mentions students weighing work against study and governments weighing space funding against education. Option D is stated when the passage claims, "*A company might invest heavily in a new product line, but doing so means giving up funds that could have been used for research, marketing, or expansion*."

107. D
The student choice is used to make the idea concrete in everyday life, so listeners can feel what a trade-off looks like. Options A and C introduce claims the lecture does not make. Option B narrows the point to academics only, which misses the broader teaching purpose.

108. C
The transition directs us to the political debate over the US space race in the 1960s, which fits option C. Options A and B shift to accounting details and private industry that the speaker does not signal. Option D jumps ahead to the 1970s and changes the topic to public opinion.

Listen to an Academic Talk #6 Transcript

Listen to a talk in an economics class.

In economics, the term opportunity cost refers to the value of what we give up when we choose one option over another. Every decision, large or small, involves a trade-off. Even when money isn't directly involved, time, energy, or resources are still being spent in one direction instead of another. Recognizing these trade-offs helps individuals and organizations make smarter choices.

Consider a student deciding whether to work part-time or focus entirely on studying. The paycheck might be appealing, but the opportunity cost is the study time and potentially higher grades that could lead to better opportunities later. Businesses face similar decisions on a larger scale. A company might invest heavily in a new product line, but doing so means giving up funds that could have been used for research, marketing, or expansion. Economists often note that overlooking these unseen costs can lead to poor decision-making.

Governments also deal with opportunity costs when setting budgets. Funding one public program can mean less money for another equally important service. During the early years of space exploration, for example, critics argued that investing billions in rockets meant fewer resources for education and poverty relief. Now, let's take a closer look at the space exploration debate in America during the 1960s to see how politicians use opportunity cost as a talking point.

Listen to an Academic Talk #7

109. C
The lecture ties methods, labor, and precision to Egyptian beliefs about order and divine power, so construction is treated as a cultural and religious expression. Options A and B isolate technique or materials without the belief system. Option D introduces modern restoration, which is not discussed.

110. D
The speaker explains that limestone blocks came from nearby quarries and were ferried along the Nile, then moved into place with ramps. Options A, B, and C describe methods that are not attributed to the primary transport step in the passage.

111. B
The pyramid is presented as both a royal tomb and a bridge to the divine, which signals political authority and spiritual meaning together. Options A and C add functions that are never claimed. Option D overgeneralizes to a regional political trend not stated.

112. D
Modern engineers are mentioned to underscore that the structure's accuracy still challenges experts today. Options A and B misread the comparison, and option C reframes the point as an industrial contrast the talk does not make.

Listen to an Academic Talk #7 Transcript

Listen to a talk in a history class.

More than four thousand years ago, ancient Egypt entered a period of extraordinary ambition under a ruler named Khufu. During his reign, workers began constructing a monument that would remain one of the world's largest structures for millennia: the Great Pyramid at Giza. The pyramid was not simply a tomb. It represented a vision of order, permanence, and divine power that defined Egyptian civilization.

The building process stretched over decades and required an enormous labor force. Contrary to old myths, the workers were not slaves but skilled laborers who lived in nearby villages. Teams cut limestone blocks from quarries along the Nile and transported them by boat to the construction site. Ramps made of mud and stone helped move each block into place, one layer at a time. The coordination of this effort suggests a sophisticated system of management, with overseers directing specialized crews for various tasks.

The precision of the final structure remains astonishing. Even today, engineers debate how ancient builders achieved such accuracy with simple tools. To the Egyptians, the monument was not only a royal tomb but a bridge between the human and divine worlds. Next, we will explore how later pyramids reflected changing ideas about kingship and the afterlife in ancient Egypt.

Listen to an Academic Talk #8

113. D
The student imagining classmates' reactions during a presentation perfectly illustrates how people build self-concept through perceived feedback. The example demonstrates how imagined judgments can shape emotion and confidence. The other options refer to different social settings that the speaker never uses to explain the theory.

114. C
The talk describes emotions such as pride, embarrassment, and anxiety, as well as growing confidence, but never mentions rejecting others' opinions. In fact, the entire concept depends on considering how others see us, so option C directly contradicts the theory.

115. A
Feedback plays a crucial role in either reinforcing or challenging how people see themselves. Over time, these reflections influence a person's identity and behavior. Option B is incorrect because the talk never claims that comparison always harms confidence. Option C minimizes the effect of reflection, while D limits it to professional growth, which is far too narrow.

116. C
Social media is mentioned to show how technology multiplies opportunities for reflection by creating more "mirrors" of how others see us. This expansion of feedback loops reinforces the theory's relevance today. Option A suggests contrast instead of continuation, Option B implies a hierarchy not stated, and Option D argues the opposite of what the talk claims.

Listen to an Academic Talk #8 Transcript

Listen to a talk in a sociology class.

In sociology, the concept of the looking-glass self explains how a person's sense of identity develops through social interaction. The term was introduced by the early sociologist Charles Horton Cooley, who suggested that people form their self-image based on how they believe others see them. In other words, we understand who we are by imagining the reflections of ourselves that others project back to us.
This process happens in three main stages. First, a person imagines how they appear to someone else. Second, they imagine how that person evaluates them. Finally, they experience an emotion, such as pride or embarrassment, based on that imagined judgment. For example, when a student gives a class presentation, they might picture how their classmates view their performance. If they imagine approval, they may feel confident; if they imagine criticism, they may feel anxious. Over time, these repeated social reflections shape the student's confidence, behavior, and even long-term self-concept.

The looking-glass self highlights the importance of feedback in social life. Our identities are not formed in isolation but through ongoing interaction with others. In modern settings, this idea extends beyond face-to-face encounters. Social media, for instance, multiplies the number of "mirrors" people encounter each day, as likes and comments reinforce or challenge their sense of self.

Listen to an Academic Talk #9

117. C
The professor explains that concrete allowed Romans to build structures that were both larger and stronger than those of earlier civilizations. This innovation marked a major step forward in architecture. Option A incorrectly says concrete limited decoration, Option B speculates about cost, but that was not the focus of the passage, and Option D exaggerates by claiming stone was completely replaced.

118. B
Roman architecture balanced artistic beauty with engineering precision. The speaker emphasizes that these buildings were both functional and grand, making option B correct. Option A reduces Roman work to imitation, Option C reverses the emphasis by focusing only on decoration, and Option D contradicts the lecture's point that Roman design continued to influence later generations.

119. B
The Colosseum and Pantheon are mentioned as direct evidence of Roman engineering skill and creativity. Each demonstrates different aspects of design—movement, structure, and symmetry. Options A, C, and D are off-topic because the lecture uses these buildings as examples, not as comparisons or historical arguments.

120. C
The professor ends by saying the next lecture will examine how Roman techniques influenced later architecture and city planning. Therefore, option C fits perfectly. The other options introduce subjects like religion, politics, or art decline, which the passage never mentions.

Listen to an Academic Talk #9 Transcript

Listen to a talk in an art history class.

The architecture of ancient Rome remains one of the most influential legacies of the classical world. Roman builders combined engineering precision with artistic ambition, producing structures that were both functional and monumental. The widespread use of concrete allowed them to create large, durable forms that earlier civilizations could not achieve. Buildings like the Colosseum and the Pantheon demonstrate this mastery. The Colosseum's tiered seating and network of corridors reveal an understanding of crowd movement, while the Pantheon's massive dome, supported by hidden arches, reflects an advanced grasp of weight distribution. These

architectural achievements were not isolated feats but part of a broader civic vision that linked architecture to empire.

Public buildings symbolized Rome's power and order. Aqueducts carried water for baths and fountains, while forums and basilicas became centers of political life. Even distant provinces adopted Roman styles as a mark of prestige and unity. When the empire eventually declined, its architectural principles endured, shaping Renaissance cathedrals and modern government buildings. Historians and engineers continue to study how Roman techniques spread through conquest and adaptation. My next lecture will examine how these methods influenced later architectural movements and the development of urban infrastructure in Europe.

Listen to an Academic Talk #10

121. D
The main idea centers on how individuals overuse shared resources and how societies attempt to solve that problem. The herder story, examples of overfishing, and discussions of policy all support this focus. Options A, B, and C narrow the topic to particular contexts or debates, while the lecture clearly presents a broader framework.

122. A
The talk makes it clear that effective management often depends on cooperation and shared responsibility. The fishing communities that limit their own catches illustrate this idea. Option B is wrong because eliminating incentives is unrealistic, Option C focuses solely on government control, and Option D ignores the importance of community traditions that are central to the examples given.

123. A
The story about herders is included to demonstrate how rational individual choices can collectively destroy a shared resource. It provides a simple and memorable illustration of the concept. The other options assign different purposes—historical, argumentative, or economic—that do not match the lecture's intent.

124. B
Some communities have responded by forming cooperative systems that manage shared resources responsibly. This solution reflects the speaker's emphasis on collaboration rather than restriction. Option A suggests people abandoned their livelihoods, Option C exaggerates government involvement, and Option D introduces imported goods, which are never mentioned.

Listen to an Academic Talk #10 Transcript

Listen to a talk in a sociology class.

The tragedy of the commons describes a situation in which individuals, pursuing their own immediate benefit, overuse and eventually destroy a shared resource. The idea was popularized by a famous ecologist who

illustrated it with a simple story about how several herders shared a common pasture. In the story, each herder gains by adding another animal, but if all the herders do so, the grass is depleted and the pasture collapses. What benefits one person in the short term harms everyone in the long run.

This dynamic appears in modern contexts such as overfishing and air pollution. Each factory or fishing boat acts rationally on its own, yet collectively they exhaust the resource they depend on. Economists and policymakers have responded with various management approaches, from government regulation to community-based agreements that assign shared responsibility. In some coastal villages, for example, local fishers cooperate by limiting catch sizes, protecting their livelihood through collective restraint.

The tragedy of the commons continues to shape debates about climate change and sustainable development. Researchers examining these cooperative systems aim to understand which social structures succeed in balancing individual incentives with the preservation of the common good.